

[FACILITATION TOOLS]

OPEN COACHING

Open coaching unlocks the depth of an unplanned presentation and sets up better experience shares. It is an EQ tool: a short run of curious questions at the front of a deep dive, never a fact-finding interview.

FIRST, CONFIRM IT IS AN EQ TOPIC [open coaching is wasted on IQ topics]

EQ · COACH IT

- ✓ The whys. Significant, unresolved, emotionally complex: fears, dreams, doubts, the conversation they are nervous to have.
- ✓ The things you cannot take to Claude or ChatGPT and get answers on.
- ✓ Earns the 30-40 minute deep dive: coaching, two minutes of silence, then experience shares.

IQ · ROUTE IT

- ✗ The what and the how. Process, details, facts and figures: comp plans, sales funnels, what everybody is doing with AI.
- ✗ Gets 10-12 minutes as a lightning round, 60 seconds each around the room.
- ✗ Not open coaching material, and never the deep dive slot.

THE PROCESS [7-8 minutes, questions only, no advice]

1. **Orient the presenter.** Three questions set the frame: "What is a single headline for the topic and the tension?" "What are 3 emotions related to the topic?" "What types of experiences are you curious to hear from the group?"
2. **Get the broad strokes.** Short, factual questions: who are the key players, is there a decision to be made or an action to be taken, has a situation like this happened before?
3. **Go where the feelings are.** Ask how the topic relates to insecurities, identity, relationships, personal values, trust. Stay curious and ask the difficult question.
4. **Guard the lane.** It is not the coach's job to console or to solve. Do not sweat transitions, and do not be afraid to interrupt a rabbit hole that is not pertinent.

CLOSE: DEFINE THE EXPERIENCE SHARE REQUEST [every request starts "A time when you felt..."]

1. **Near-exact.** Same situation, same feelings. "A time when you felt undermined by a business partner's lack of leadership."
2. **Same emotions, different situation.** "A time when you felt that same tension confronting someone on an awkward topic."
3. **The other side.** A different seat in the same situation. "A time when you felt exposed because someone confronted you about a weakness of yours."

"Resonance, not relevance. An experience share is whatever resonated with you, not an identical situation."

COLTON MULLIGAN, FORUM TRAININGS, MAY-JUNE 2026

Sources: Created by Colton Mulligan for Forum Playbook. v2.0 updates his open coaching tips sheet (ForumSherpa era 2022; FP v1.0a April 2026) with the current opening language and the EQ vs IQ frame. Companion: EQ vs IQ Topics: Sizing the Conversation.